

CITY COUNCIL WEB PAGES

City Of Santa Monica | Office Of Technology | Information Services Department

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Keywords:

Website Migration; City Council; Web Design; User Experience

Summary:

As part of a citywide **website migration**, I led the information architecture and design work for Santa Monica's City Council web experience. I conducted **stakeholder research** to synthesize city and user requirements, established **UX principles** to guide design decisions, and developed an information architecture that balanced user needs with organizational priorities. Using **Figma**, I created high-fidelity designs and ensured the solution aligned with **CMS capabilities**, implementation constraints, and long-term content management processes.

CITY COUNCIL WEBSITE MIGRATION

CITY OF SANTA MONICA
OFFICE OF INFORMATION SERVICES
Jeremy Peterson — Technology Program Manager



Designing city council web information around resident needs, making government more transparent, accessible, and equitable so every community member can easily find information and participate in local decision-making.

PROBLEM & GOALS

BACKGROUND

- Prior to 2020, Santa Monica's web architecture existed across 200 domains and 50 different websites.
- Content migration and redesign is ongoing, with 15% of content remaining to be transferred, reviewed and restructured to align with current city goals and priorities.
- Migrating content to the new website is essential for providing more intuitive, brand-aligned, equitable, and ADA compliant ways for residents to access important civic information.

Part of a larger project to synthesize

200 DOMAINS AND 50 DIFFERENT WEBSITES

into a single cohesive website, [SantaMonica.gov](https://santamonica.gov)

PROBLEM AND GOAL

Problem:

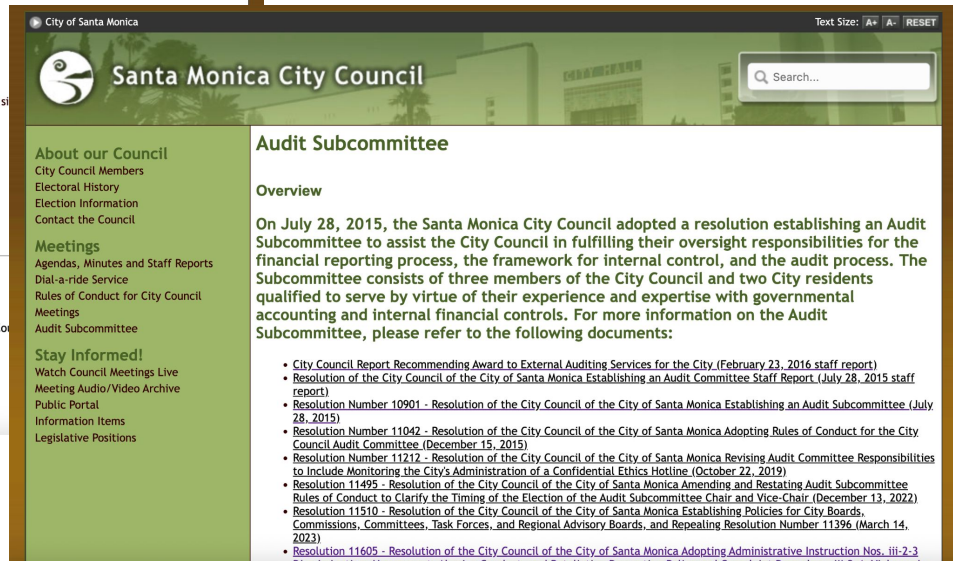
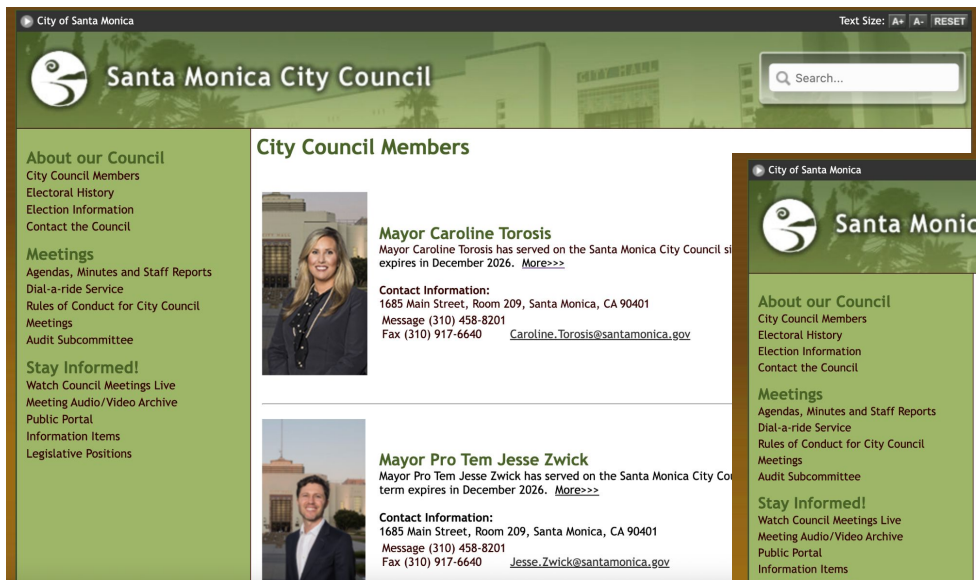
- A series of pages dedicated to city council lives on Santa Monica's legacy website, smgov.net.

Goal:

- Design a new website architecture and page designs related to Santa Monica's City Council that align with resident expectations and current civic processes on santamonica.gov.



LEGACY WEBSITE



LANDSCAPE AUDIT

Analysis of public and private sector examples of web experiences with similar goals and information types.



Fig 1.1 Boston City Council webpage.

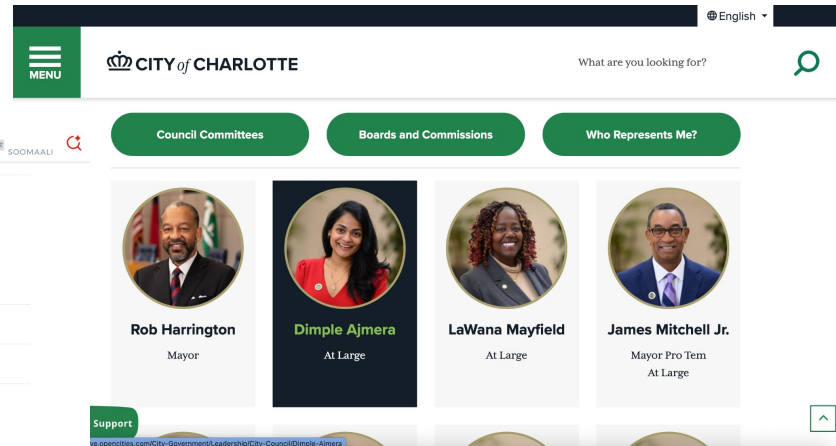


Fig 1.2 Charlotte City Council webpage.

STAKEHOLDER INSIGHTS

- **Optimize the information architecture** to make key Council resources easier to find from the homepage, including elevating key cited CTAs like contact information for the council.
- **Replace open-text fields** for City Council bios with more structured pieces of content that correspond to form fields in the website CMS.
- **Streamline content management** by removing outdated pages, preserving legally required and recent council records, and reducing unnecessary legacy content and consolidating content where appropriate.

TECH STACK



Orchard Core



Figma

RESULTS



Refined submenu to align with user goals

CITY COUNCIL

| MEET THE COUNCIL | NEWS | LEGISLATIVE ACTIONS | MEETING AGENDAS | CONTACT US
| ELECTION INFORMATION

The Santa Monica City Council is made up of seven members elected by the community. As the legislative authority, City Council sets the policies, priorities, and budget for the local government. The City Council provides leadership through policy development regarding the current practices and future vision of the City as well as the adoption and oversight of the City budget.

MEET THE COUNCIL



Mayor Caroline Torosis



Mayor Pro Tem Jesse Zwick



Councilmember Lana Negrete



Councilmember Dan Hall



Councilmember Ellis Roskin

See Full

CONTACT THE COUNCIL

CONTACT



Contact the council elevated in menu hierarchy

Strategic use of existing Orchard Core modules

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Press Release



Tati Simonian

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December 11, 2024 1:32 PM

Press Release



Tati Simonian

Nikima Newsome named city clerk

July 9, 2024 11:04 AM

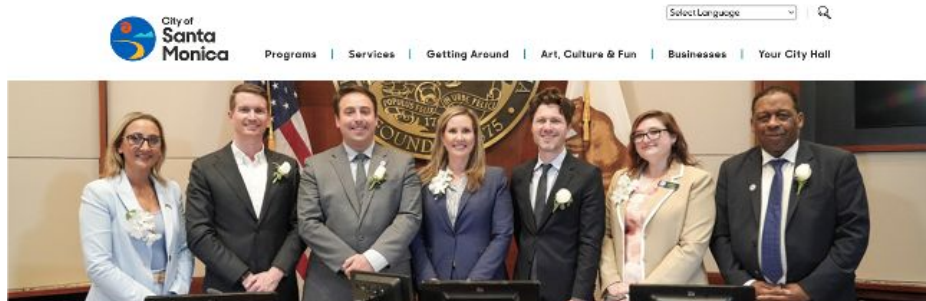
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Hoverstate photo selection for each council member



RESULTS



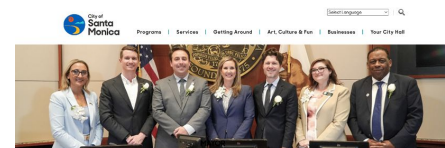
MEET THE COUNCIL



Mayor Caroline Torosis

Caroline Torosis is a lifelong community advocate and public servant. At the time of her election to City Council in November 2022, Caroline had been serving our community as a Commissioner on the Santa Monica Rent Control Board since 2016. A proud UCLA alumna, she is a government affairs attorney and workforce and economic development expert with a J.D. from Washington University. In her full-time job, she is the Senior Deputy for Economic and Workforce Development to create lasting positive impact for the residents. (...)

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MAYOR CAROLINE TOROSIS



2022-PRESENT

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Caroline.Torosis@santamonica.gov

Caroline Torosis is a lifelong community advocate and public servant. At the time of her election to City Council in November 2022, Caroline had been serving our community as a Commissioner on the Santa Monica Rent Control Board since 2016. A proud UCLA alumna, she is a government affairs attorney and workforce and economic development expert with a J.D. from Washington University. In her full-time job, she is the Senior Deputy for Economic and Workforce Development for the Los Angeles County Board of Supervisors. Supervisor Michael Bonin is also a member of the County's Women's Leadership Council. Previously, Caroline worked as the Director of Economic and Business Development for Los Angeles County Workforce Development, Aging and Community Services. Throughout the Coronavirus pandemic, Caroline spearheaded the County's economic recovery response, directing efforts to deliver financial relief to small, local businesses, and expanding innovative policies to protect our front-line workers and residents. As a past Commissioner on the Santa Monica Rent Control Board, she worked to increase public transparency and collaborated with both tenants and landlords to maximize spending experience and keep residents in their homes.

Mayor Torosis has dedicated her career to passing policies that protect the rights of our workers, consumers, and tenants while allowing our small businesses to provide the best and safest neighborhoods. Since her election to the Council, she has continued to uphold policies that support local residents and businesses, promote economic recovery, protect gun-free zones, and ensure transparency, sustainable solutions to homelessness. She will continue fighting diligently for social equity and economic recovery and hopes to continue having positive impact for the residents and history of Santa Monica.

[more councilmember bios >](#)

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Creation of additional form fields for years served + contact information

Dedicated council bios with cohesive design across pages



NEXT STEPS + REFLECTION

- An additional round of stakeholder consultation
- Prepare design specifications for developer handoff
- Measure post-launch outcomes with G4A analytics and user feedback



THANK YOU

Thank you to Jeremy Peterson and the entire Santa Monica city team for supporting this project, along with Cassie Rubio and the entire Coding It Forward team.